

Pride Family - Win26

Designing and Developing a Web Platform for
LGBTQIA+ Community Support

10.26.25-02.26.26


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[Log in](#)
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Welcome to Pride Family

We match LGBTQIA+ adults with safe, supportive chosen families.

[Find Your Chosen Family](#)
[Become a Chosen Family](#)

Want to help? [Donate](#) to support our mission.





Matching

Through thoughtful questionnaires and careful matching, we connect LGBTQIA+ individuals with supportive families and friends who share their interests.

[Seeking a chosen family](#)
[Becoming a chosen family](#)

Pride Family

Donate

Webpage Donations

Choose amount

One-time

Monthly

\$10

\$50

\$100

☐ Write us a comment

Quick Contact Summary

[Crisis & Mental Health](#)
[Mental Health](#)
[Community](#)
[Legal & Advocacy](#)
[Health & Wellness](#)
[Youth & Family](#)
[Older Adult](#)



In Crisis? Call 988 or The Trevor Project at 1-866-488-7386

Free, confidential support available 24/7

Quick Contact Summary

Crisis and Immediate Support

988 Suicide and Crisis Lifeline
☎ 988
Trevor Project
☎ 1-866-488-7386
☎ 1-866-488-7386
☎ Text START to 678-678
Trans Lifeline
☎ 1-877-565-8860
LGBT National Help Center
☎ 1-888-843-4564
Crisis Text Line
☎ Text 741741

Community & Advocacy

CenterLink
☎ 954-765-6024
HRC, Lambda Legal, PFLAG
🌐 Info via respective websites
National Center for Transgender Equality
☎ 202-642-4542

Older Adult Support

SAGE LGBT Elder Hotline
☎ 877-360-5428

Health and Youth Services

🌐 [OutCare Health directory](#)
Runaway Safeline
☎ 1-877-565-8860

About Pride Family

Pride Family is a nonprofit organization dedicated to supporting LGBTQIA+ adults who have been disowned or lack acceptance from their families.

- Connects LGBTQIA+ individuals with safe, compassionate **"chosen families"**
- Chosen families are trusted adults and households offering **long-term emotional support, connection, and care**
- Reduces isolation and helps mitigate the harmful impacts of family rejection
- Empowers LGBTQIA+ individuals to live **safely, authentically, and with a sense of belonging**



Project Objective

At the start of this batch, Pride Family's website had **partial functionality** and **inconsistent design** across pages. Our goal was to transform it into a **cohesive, secure, and accessible platform** that clearly communicates the organization's mission and enables safe engagement for LGBTQIA+ individuals and chosen families.

Core Deliverables:

- Redesign and standardize UI across all main pages to align with Pride Family's brand
- Build a cohesive landing page with clear calls to action
- Implement a fully functional donation flow (button + modal integration)
- Fix and improve the "Forgot Password" login flow
- Develop Contact and Resources pages to provide safe, accessible support
- Ensure full responsiveness across desktop, tablet, and mobile
- Implement scalable patterns/templates for future growth

This project directly supports LGBTQIA+ adults experiencing family rejection by reducing friction in accessing support and chosen family connections.



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Find Your Chosen Family

Become a Chosen Family

Want to help? [Donate](#) to support our mission.

Project Timeline

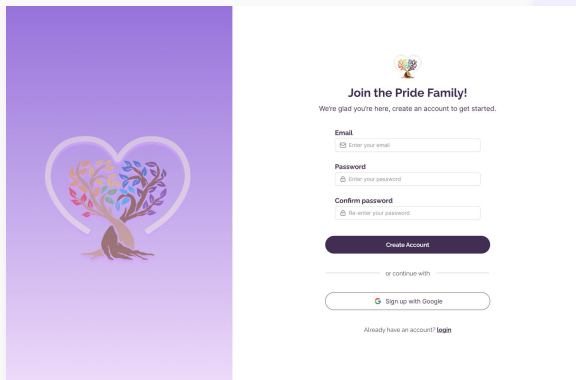


Project Scoping

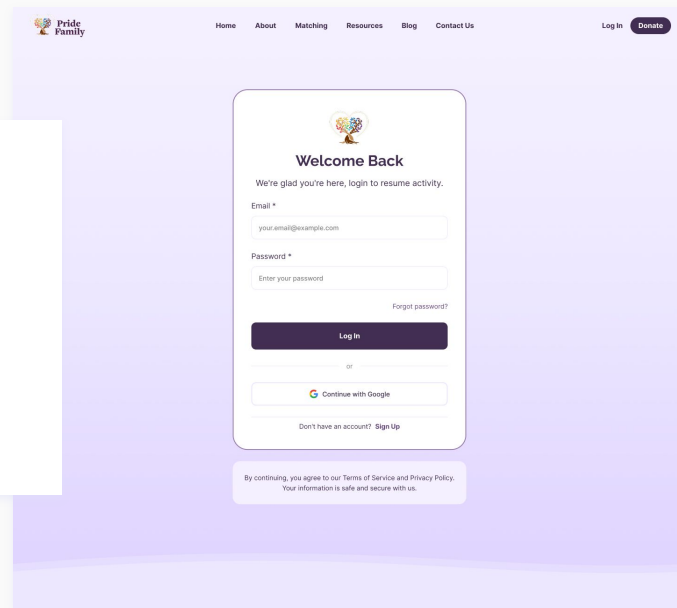
Focus on **aligning client's goals with user needs** before wireframing

Goal: Design and develop **cohesive, accessible pages** across Home, About, Matching, Resources, Blog, and Login, with donation linking and confirmation

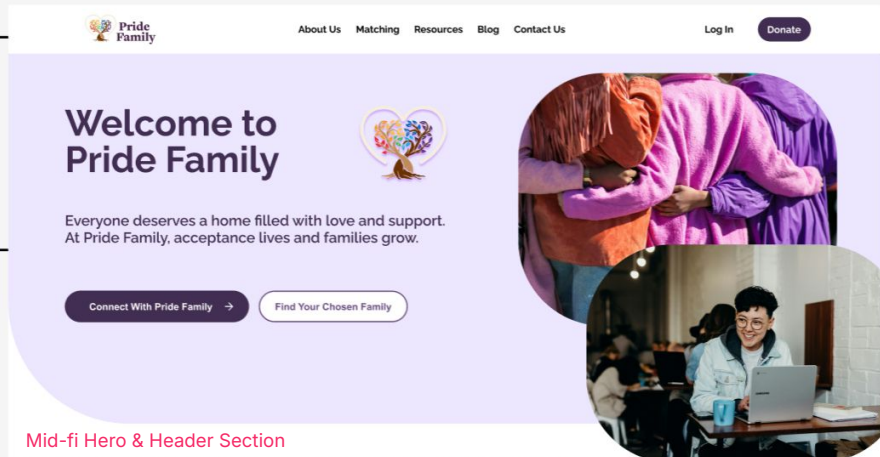
Goal: Update the **UI system** to match Pride Family's new design criteria and improve consistency across components



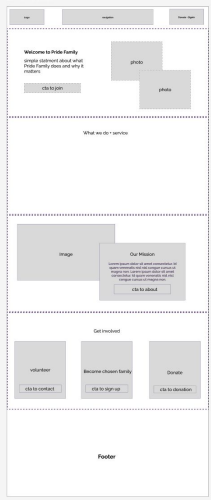
Previous existing design



Our final design



Mid-fi Hero & Header Section



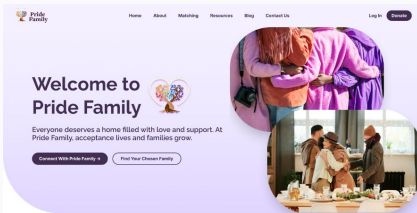
Low-fi Landing Page

Mid-fi Contact Form

Design Process

- **Planning Phase:** define core user flows, page requirements, information architecture, competitive analysis, and brand definition
- **Low-fi Wireframe** → explore content placement, layout variations, and visualize early ideas for each page
- **Mid-fi Wireframe** → focuses on defining major elements in design, such as navigation, header, hero, footer sections, key functionality and interaction patterns

Before Final Iteration



How it started

As a mother of two gay sons, I always wanted them to know one thing above all else: their father and I would love and accept them unconditionally. But as they grew older, I quickly learned that not every child receives the same kind of love.

My oldest son often brought friends home for Christmas, Thanksgiving, and Easter—kids who didn't have a welcoming place to go. We pulled them into our loud, chaotic holiday traditions without hesitation. They helped bring Christmas lights the day after Thanksgiving, bringing in the old fog along with my own kids. Emotional attachment with homemade turkey noodle soup and hot chocolate. We gave them Christmas gifts, Easter baskets, and a visit at the lake to open Easter eggs.

In my heart, I knew our home could never replace their own families—but I wanted them to feel seen, embraced, and part of something.

[Read More](#)

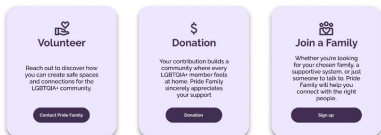


Our Mission

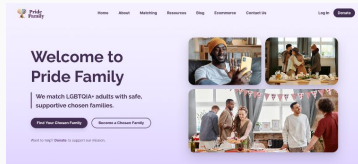
Pride Family connects LGBTQIA+ community members who have not been accepted by their families with safe and compassionate chosen families. Our core mission and goal is a world where everyone, regardless of their sexual orientation or gender identity, feels accepted and loved by their chosen family.

In doing so, we seek to eliminate the percentage of LGBTQIA+ individuals who engage in harmful behavior by fostering supportive relationships that provide mental well-being and empower individuals to live authentically.

Connect with Pride Family



Final Iteration



Our Mission

Pride Family connects LGBTQIA+ people with chosen families who offer support, stability, and care. For members who have experienced discrimination or trauma, we provide safe matching and a private community to help build lasting belonging.

[Safety First](#)

[Privacy Guaranteed](#)

[Support That Lasts](#)

What We Provide

[Matching](#)

Browse families and get matched with your ideal family. We'll take care of all other details for you.

[Secure messaging](#)

Message safely on the platform. We'll ensure all members sharing personal details.

[Moderation](#)

Community guidelines and moderation to help keep people safe.

[Learn how matching works](#)



Pride Family began with a simple goal: make sure no one feels alone.

How It Started

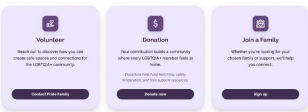
As a mother of two gay sons, I always wanted them to know one thing above all else: their father and I would love and accept them unconditionally. But as they grew older, I quickly learned that not every child receives the same kind of love.

We often saw other brought friends home for Christmas, Thanksgiving, and Easter—kids who didn't have a welcoming place to go. We pulled them into our loud, chaotic holiday traditions without hesitation. They helped bring Christmas lights the day after Thanksgiving, bringing in the old fog along with my own kids. Emotional attachment with homemade turkey noodle soup and hot chocolate. We gave them Christmas gifts, Easter baskets, and a visit at the lake to open Easter eggs.

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[Read our story](#)

Connect with Pride Family



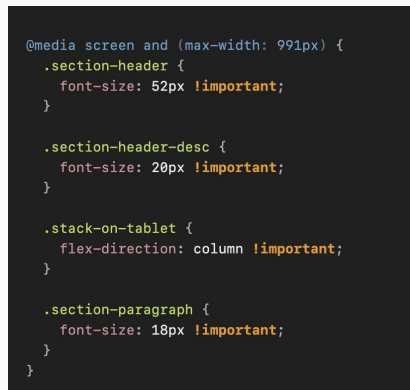
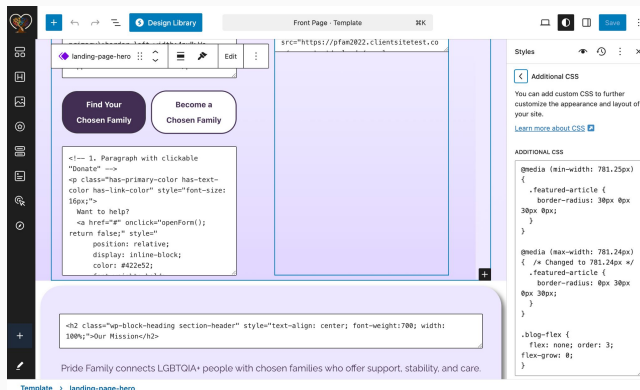
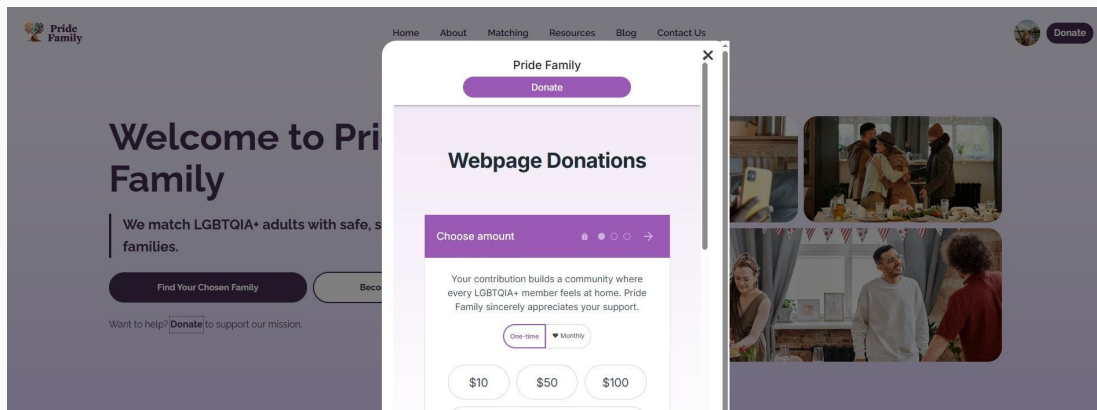
Design Process

- **High-fi Wireframe + Prototyping** → Finalized visual design and interactions, ensuring cohesive branding, improved readability, and an intuitive core user flow
- **User Testing** → Conducted surveys with target users to gather insights on navigation, core user flow, content clarity, and overall user experience
- **Final Iteration** → Updated design based on feedback provided from user testing, enhancing usability, and resolving friction points



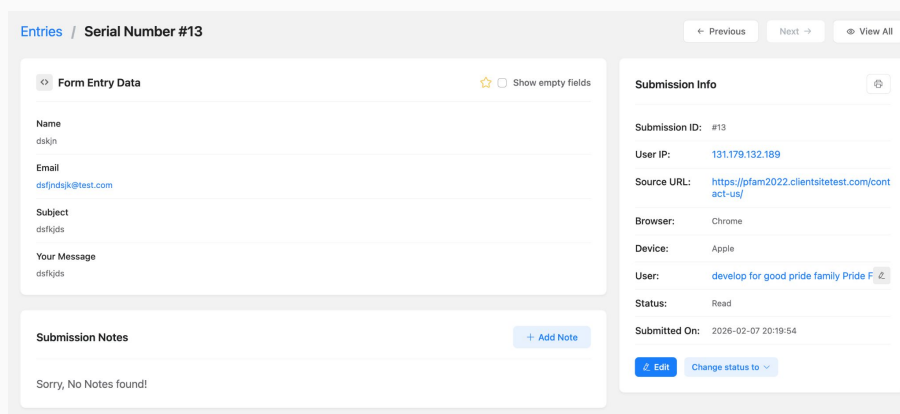
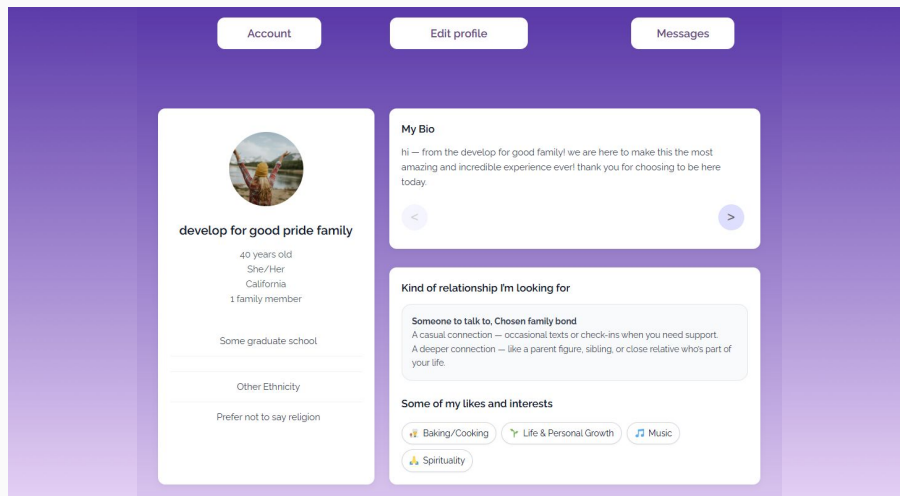
Development Process

- **Hybrid no-code + custom HTML/CSS/JavaScript approach** with emphasis on **accessibility**
- **Planning Phase:** reference prototypes, decide tech stack, expand on mobile wireframes
- **Implementation Phase:** set up core page layout, add functionality with custom HTML, iterate based on hi-fi designs
- **Tools used:** WordPress block editor, plugins (**Spectra** for advanced block editing), **patterns** and **templates**



Development Process

- **Core functions implemented:** **Contact Us form**, **Edit Profile** feature, and **donation pop-up**
- **Plugins used:** **Ultimate Member** (contact form and Edit Profile), **Fluent Forms + Fluent Community** (contact form)
- Form responses and profile edits **automatically associated with users** and synced with Ultimate Member





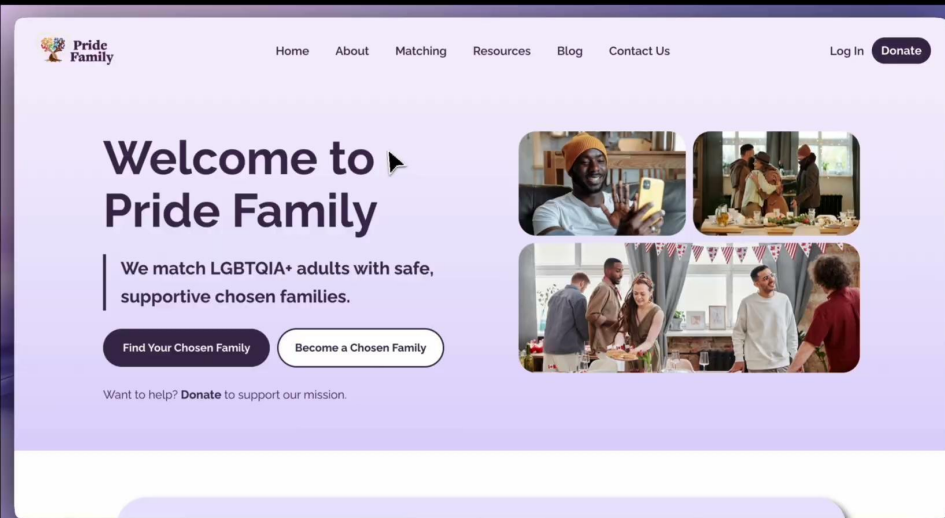
5 of 6 participants reported a safe,
welcoming experience

Safety signals were clear early, supporting the
mission and signup flow.

Final point

**We didn't just redesign a website—
we strengthened Pride Family's
ability to safely connect
LGBTQIA+ individuals with chosen
families.**

*This platform is now secure, fully
responsive, functionally complete,
and scalable for future
development.*

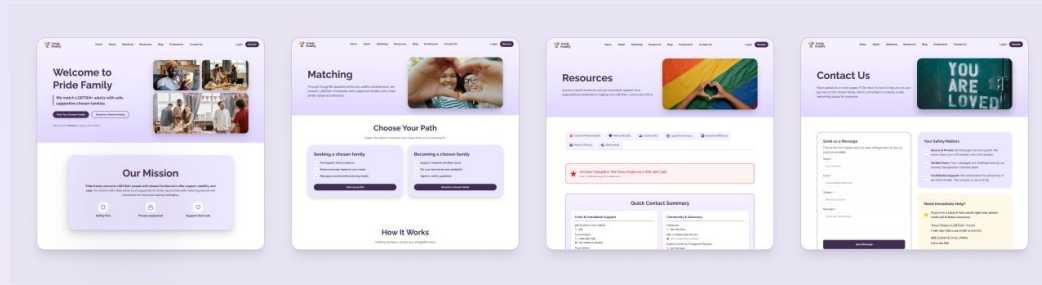


"Develop for Good has been an amazing partner, helping Pride Family grow and make a real impact."

- Client Testimonial from Michele Ellenberger

Key Takeaway

Our team successfully transformed a partially built platform into a fully deployed, cohesive, and secure website that enables LGBTQIA+ individuals to find safe, long-term chosen family support.

A 'Welcome Back' login form. At the top is a logo with the text 'Welcome Back'. Below it is the text 'We're glad you're here, login to resume activity.' The form has two input fields: 'Email *' with the placeholder 'your.email@example.com' and 'Password *' with the placeholder 'Enter your password'. There is a 'Forgot password?' link. A dark blue 'Log In' button is below the password field. Below the button is the text 'or' and a 'Continue with Google' button. At the bottom is the text 'Don't have an account? Sign Up'. At the very bottom is a disclaimer: 'By continuing, you agree to our Terms of Service and Privacy Policy. Your information is safe and secure with us.'